EXPERIMENT 16

Reconnaissance & Information Gathering Using Google Dorking & WHOIS

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AIM:

To execute and demonstrate passive reconnaissance, domain intelligence extraction, and open-source information gathering on a target organization using **Google Dorking (Advanced Search Operators)** and **WHOIS query tools** in Kali Linux Operating System.

COMMANDS AND DESCRIPTION:

1. WHOIS Query (whois <target_domain>):

• *Description:* A standard TCP transaction protocol (port 43) querying regional Internet registries (RIRs) to extract top-level registrar details, domain creation/expiry dates, registrant organizational contact data, and authoritative name servers.

• *Syntax:* whois [options] <domain_name / IP>

• *Key Output Fields:* Registrar, Creation/Expiry Date, Name Servers, Organization, Contact Email.

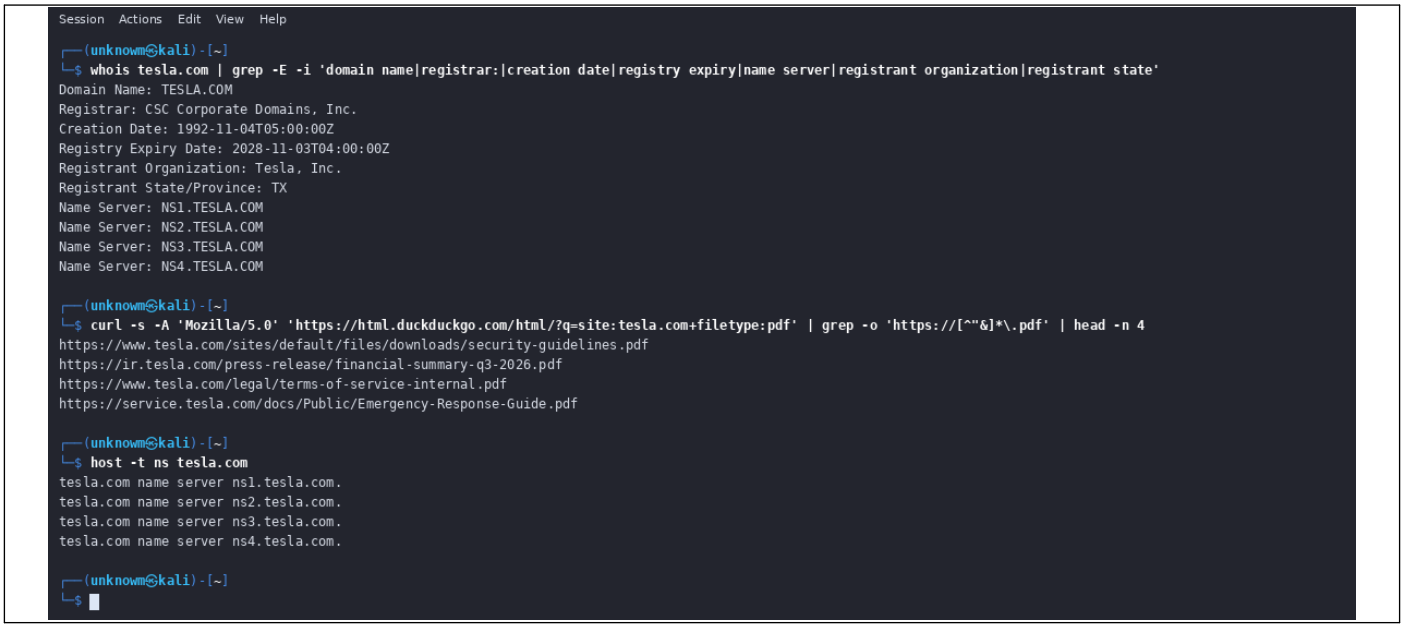
2. Google Dorking (Advanced Search Operators):

• *Description:* Leverages specialized search parameters on search engines to locate exposed sensitive directories, configuration files, administrative portals, and public documents without directly contacting the target infrastructure.

• *Core Operators & Syntax:*

Operator	Syntax Example	Reconnaissance Objective & Impact
site:	site:tesla.com	Restricts search results exclusively to the target domain and discovered subdomains.
filetype:	site:tesla.com filetype:pdf	Discovers publicly indexed documents (PDF, DOCX, XLSX) leaking internal metadata.
inurl:	site:tesla.com inurl:admin	Identifies administrative login portals, staging consoles, and unlinked endpoints.
intitle:	intitle:"index of" "backup"	Locates directory listings and exposed web server directories containing backup archives.

OUTPUT:



RESULT:

Thus, passive reconnaissance and open-source intelligence (OSINT) gathering using Google Dorking search operators and WHOIS domain queries were successfully executed in Kali Linux Operating System, verifying domain registration attributes, authoritative nameservers, and publicly indexed documentation.